

A workspace for reviewing financial marketing, returning corrections, and recording exactly what was approved.

Problem and working hypothesis

ClearPath's brief identifies an Excel/email approval bottleneck, but not its cause. My reconstruction: email carries creative, questions, and revisions; Excel tracks status and ownership; reviewers manually reconcile both. The opportunity is to reduce that reconstruction and incomplete correction rounds. This is a hypothesis, not a finding from ClearPath customer interviews.

Understanding the work

Reviewers assess a consumer-facing promise against the applicable product terms, supporting evidence, presentation, and intended use. One submission may include an image, caption, and destination. Affiliates need actionable feedback; partner managers need the next owner; compliance needs the exact version and basis for its decision. A revised file does not necessarily answer every request.

Decision and priorities

I chose an approval workspace over a compliance scanner or template library because coordination most directly addresses the stated workflow. The call emphasized getting consequential interactions right within the take-home scope.

Keep the review together. Material, cited sources, findings, and returned evidence can be inspected alongside one another. Original files and versions remain available.

Preserve unresolved work. Corrections and evidence requests have explicit human dispositions. Required unresolved findings block approval; a partial revision does not clear the case.

Separate audiences and handoffs. Affiliates use a submission/return page, not the internal workspace. Reviewers deliberately share instructions and decisions; private reasoning stays out of that external view.

Bound the decision. Approval identifies a package, reference, and use scope. Changed material requires a new review. A withdrawn supporting reference blocks sharing an earlier approval.

Research and assumptions

Regulation Z's actual-terms requirements informed versioned offer references; its conditional disclosure rules mean a factually correct claim can still need further disclosures. FTC substantiation policy informed requests for evidence, while digital-disclosure guidance made visual inspection essential. These sources shape what reviewers inspect; they do not mandate our UI or certify its decisions.[1-4]

Published partner procedures include campaign context, source files, and email revision rounds.[5] V1 deliberately uses a portal to complete that loop reliably. Email integration remains valuable; the portal is not evidence that affiliates prefer changing their workflow. PNG/JPEG and PDF are the bounded preview scope, not a claim that all incoming material uses those formats.

Evidence, limits, and next decisions

The build, 33 API tests, and 19 browser tests passed, with a manual submission-to-shared-decision walkthrough. Authored samples demonstrate workflow, not automated detection or legal accuracy. No throughput gain has been measured.

Known gaps remain: new responses do not gate approval, and changed request obligations can be missed by the re-sharing indicator. Those come before broader features. Production also needs authenticated access, notifications, durable operations, and approval lifecycle controls. Automated legal decisions, exhaustive rule coverage, and post-publication monitoring are outside V1.

With a real team, I would observe completed cases and measure active reviewer time, correction rounds, waiting by owner, and missed handoffs. That would test whether coordination is actually the limiting step.

[1: Regulation Z §§1026.16 / 1026.24](#) · [2: Design basis](#) · [3: FTC substantiation](#) · [4: FTC digital disclosures](#) · [5: Affirm submission process](#)